

OPEN SOURCE CAN HELP INDIA ACCELERATE DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION ACROSS INDUSTRIES, CLAIMS RED HAT

Gone are the days when the world of open source software was limited to a handful of developers. In the last decade, it has gained acceptance from and been embraced by enterprises. Today, open source development stands for stability, security and innovation.

By opening the code to widespread examination, more and more people participate in finding its bugs and security flaws, and in offering new ideas. When we think of open source, one of the first names to come to mind is that of Red Hat. The company has been involved in open source communities since its inception more than two decades ago. From Linux to Apache in the 1990s to Kubernetes and the Cloud Native Computing Foundation, the company is a part of hundreds of open source communities and trade groups.

Hitesh Sahijwaala, director – sales, Red Hat India and South Asia, talked about the evolution of open source in India, and how the Indian government and enterprises have both realised the benefits of opting for it over closed source, in an exclusive chat with Syeda Beenish, consulting editor, *OSFY*. The excerpts follow...

Q How has open source evolved to become the new norm for enterprises?

Digital transformation continues to be the top priority in every board room across verticals. As a result, more and more enterprises are leveraging technologies such as the cloud, mobile, Big Data and social media, coupled with organisational innovation to create new ways of doing business to drive growth and differentiate themselves from competitors. Open source is seen as a default choice for enterprises.

Technology is changing too fast and open source can help businesses keep up with the pace.

Our 25 years of experience has proved to us how open standards bring people together to collaborate. It unlocks the potential of solving complex problems across various industries, such as financial services, telcos and governments. User participation in emerging technology trends, such as the cloud and containers, is strongly driven by open source. In simple words, open source not only helps organisations meet their current needs but future business demands too.



Hitesh Sahijwaala,
director – sales, Red Hat India

“UIDAI is built on an open, scalable and secure architecture to meet the needs of the Aadhaar project.”

Q How do you see open source in India? Is there anything unique about how the Indian market has adopted open source?

Today, open source software has become the de facto delivery model

for all types of enterprise software and is at the core of every emerging technology. It allows an organisation to build an ecosystem that is robust and secure. It promotes faster innovation, enabling firms to scale up, modify and add new features according to the changing trends and customer demands. The introduction of a well-defined open source policy and its successful embracement by the Indian government has further boosted adoption, and has helped even the sceptical users to adopt the technology.

In my view, there are many key drivers of open source adoption in India. One is the fact that ours is the fastest growing major economy; second is the impetus given to large scale infrastructure projects by government led initiatives like Digital India or Make in India and third, all this is backed by a huge pool of developers who not only use open source but also actively contribute to the community.

I see a tremendous opportunity for open source in India, to help the country accelerate digital transformation across industries such as BFSI, telecom, services and so on. In fact, open source